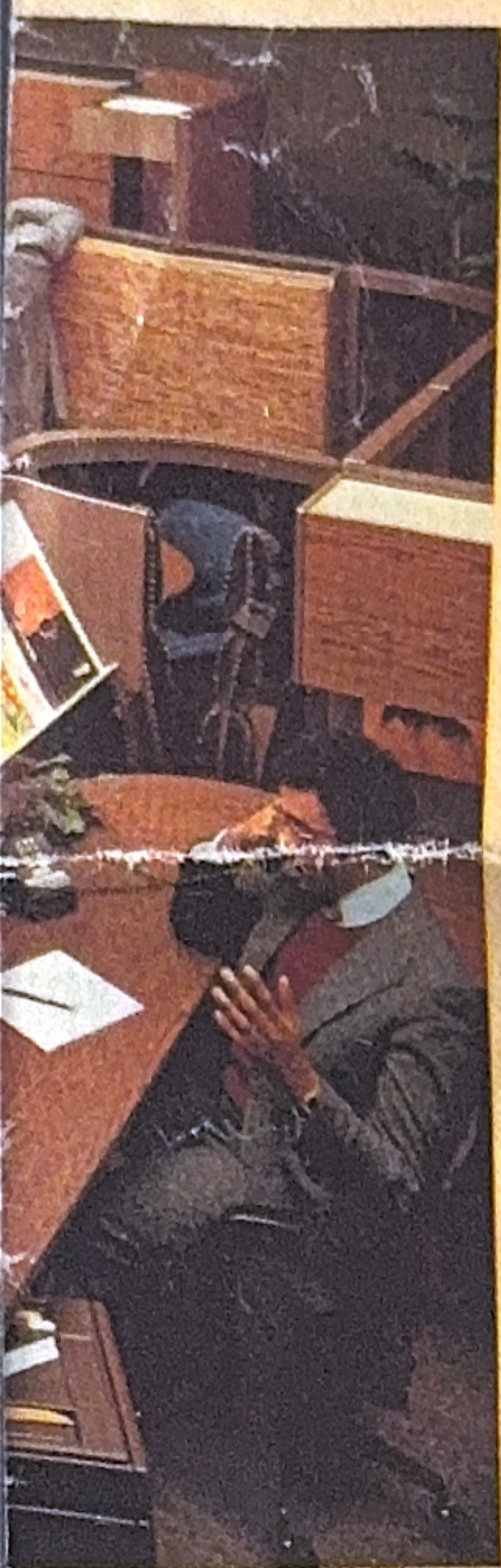


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Happy Cooker

nately with eggs and sugar. Beat in pumpkin, apple butter, flour, spices and liqueur. Beat in heavy cream on low speed (if using a food processor, do this step by hand). Pour filling into prepared crust and bake at 425° for 15 minutes; reduce heat to 275° and bake 1 hour longer. Leave cake in turned-off oven, with door slightly ajar, until cool. Garnish with whipped cream and candied ginger. Ta-daah!

Excellent

Almond Absurdity

Barbara Slavin

"This is a showy and absolutely delicious dessert...if you like almonds," claims Slavin.

Almond Absurdity Crust:

1 cup graham or vanilla wafer crumbs
½ cup toasted almonds, ground fine
¼ cup melted margarine
2 tablespoons sugar
1 tablespoon almond-flavored liqueur (Amaretto)

Place all ingredients in bowl of food

I had considered her inclusion of apple butter in the cheesecake sinful; now with the addition of a shortbread crust and liqueur, I knew we were damned to perdition.

processor with steel blade and process till well blended. Press with fingers into a 10-inch springform pan and refrigerate while making filling.

Filling:

4 ounces almond paste
½ cup sugar
2 tablespoons flour
⅓ cup Amaretto
3 (8-ounce) packages cream cheese
4 eggs

Place all ingredients in bowl of food processor and blend till smooth. Pour into chilled crust and bake in preheated 325° oven for 50 minutes. Remove from oven and add topping.

Topping:

1 cup sour cream
3 tablespoons amaretto
2 tablespoons sugar

Mix all ingredients and spread over partially cooked cake; return to oven and bake an additional 20 minutes. Cool and refrigerate. To garnish, place ¼ cup sliced blanched almonds, end-up around edge of cheesecake. □

Mary Ellen Carter is food editor of Richmond LifeStyle.